

Abnormal Security

AI Email / Behavioral Security · San Francisco, CA · Private (\$5.1B; \$200M+ ARR; IPO-track)

Abnormal Security raised a \$250M Series D at \$5.1B and is signalling public-company readiness - an AI-security leader with the budget and brand mandate, a CMO seat in transition, and no motorsport presence.

72

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Haas

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Abnormal Security, an AI behavioral-security leader, raised a \$250M Series D at a \$5.1B valuation and has publicly stated it wants to be able to operate as a public company. It has the capacity and the brand-building motive of a pre-IPO leader, sits in the open cybersecurity category on the F1 grid, and has never entered motorsport. A useful nuance: its marketing leadership is in transition (the prior CMO, Doug Laird, is no longer listed on the current executive team, which now shows VP-level product and revenue marketing), so brand and sponsorship strategy is being re-decided - approach the CEO and help shape it.

WHY NOW

Pre-IPO leaders invest in enterprise brand to support a future listing, the cybersecurity category on the grid rewards a first mover, and the open CMO seat means the strategic framing set now will define the incoming hire's plan. There is no competitor clock yet, so the work here is to create the urgency rather than react to it - which favours an early, relationship-led approach.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$5.1B

Valuation (Series D, Aug 2024; \$250M round)

\$200M+

Annual recurring revenue (100%+ YoY growth)

\$557M

Total raised (Insight, Menlo, Wellington)

Evan Reiser

CEO & co-founder (since 2018; ex-Twitter)

CMO vacant

CMO seat in transition (Doug Laird departed; VP-level marketing)

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Haas	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Williams	TAKEN	data platform / storage, identity & access security
McLaren	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

An AI email-security leader at \$5.1B and \$200M+ ARR (100%+ growth), IPO-track, with the CMO seat in transition - the moment to plant a thesis the incoming marketing hire inherits. Cybersecurity is open on the F1 grid; Haas is the lean, ownable first step, and email/finance-fraud protection is a real MODE-A deployment.

NEVER ENTERED

FUNDING EVENT

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY HAAS

Haas offers an accessible, lean entry tier with open enterprise-software and security categories - a sensible first motorsport step at a sensible price for a company making its debut in the space, with room to scale to a bigger team at the next contract if the model proves out.

VALUE TO HAAS — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - real substance on three fronts. (1) TECHNICAL/SECURITY: an F1 team is a prime target for business-email-compromise and social-engineering attacks - finance and partnerships staff move large sponsor and supplier sums, and the team guards high-value design IP - so a behavioral-AI email-security deployment protecting the team's inboxes and finance workflows is genuine, deployable protection and a flagship reference. (2) COMMERCIAL: Haas's paddock audience reaches the CISO/IT buyers Abnormal sells to, so hospitality becomes a working enterprise pipeline channel, and an 'official security partner of an F1 team' badge carries real CISO credibility. (3) CONTENT & TALENT: a 'securing the team that races' narrative plus a security-engineering recruiting halo. The team gains real protection and aligned co-marketing; Abnormal gains a live reference deployment and a premium enterprise stage ahead of its IPO.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Security Partner tier on Haas, minimum three years, ~\$2.5-4M/yr, with category exclusivity and a working deployment protecting the team's email and finance functions.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Evan Reiser
CEO & CO-FOUNDER, ABNORMAL SECURITY - VERIFIED (NOTE: CMO SEAT IN TRANSITION; CURRENT TEAM SHOWS VP-LEVEL MARKETING)
CEO and co-founder, and the owner of Abnormal's IPO-readiness narrative and top-level brand direction while the CMO role is unsettled - the right entry point today. Approach Reiser directly and offer a ready-made sponsorship thesis for the incoming marketing leader to execute.

OPENING ANGLE

"Evan, pre-IPO is exactly when enterprise brand compounds, security is wide open on the F1 grid, and Haas is the smart, ownable first step. With the CMO seat in flux, this is your call - 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 15 / 20 Raised \$250M Series D at \$5.1B (2024) and has publicly targeted public-company readiness; the CMO seat is currently in transition (Doug Laird departed), so brand strategy is open.	CAPACITY 16 / 20 \$5.1B valuation and \$200M+ ARR growing 100%+ YoY (\$557M raised) - comfortably funds a value-to-mid tier.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 AI behavioral security sits in the open cybersecurity category on the grid.	URGENCY 12 / 20 An IPO-readiness window exists, but there is no acute external forcing function yet.	OPS FIT 14 / 20 MODE A: every team faces targeted phishing and business-email compromise - a real, demonstrable security use case.
--	--	---	--	--

RISKS & COUNTERS

SPEND DISCIPLINE PRE-IPO Public-company preparation favours visible efficiency. **Counter:** Lead with a value-tier entry and measurable B2B pipeline outcomes, not title-level spend.

LEADERSHIP GAP An unsettled CMO seat could delay a decision. **Counter:** Engage the CEO and frame the deal as a turnkey win to hand the new marketing leader on arrival.

SOURCES

- <https://abnormal.ai/about/news/series-d-5b-valuation>
- <https://www.cnbc.com/2024/08/06/new-funding-values-email-security-firm-abnormal-at-more-than-5-billion.html>
- <https://news.crunchbase.com/cybersecurity/startup-ai-abnormal-security-funding-wellington/>
- <https://www.crunchbase.com/person/evan-reiser>
- <https://abnormal.ai/about/team>
- <https://www.morningstar.com/stocks/ipos-make-comeback-these-9-cybersecurity-startups-could-be-next>